

Word family: **chance / chances / chanced / chancing / chancy**

Base word: chance

Plural: chances

Past tense: chanced

Past participle: chanced

** -ing form:** chancing

Related form: chancy

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related form (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “If I ever got the **chance**, I would love to sit down with him again and talk about those carefree days.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **chance** means an **opportunity to do something**.

The speaker means that if an opportunity arose to meet Ryan again, he would gladly talk with him about their childhood.

繁體中文： **可以做某件事的機會或合適時機；機會**

中文翻譯：

> “If I ever got the **chance**, I would love to sit down with him again...”

「如果我將來有**機會**，我很想再跟他坐下來聊聊.....」

Here:

get the chance to do something = 得到 / 有機會做某事

1. **chance = opportunity (機會) — 機會；時機**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: An opportunity or suitable occasion to do something.

Practice 1 — Original

> “If I ever got the **chance**, I would love to talk to him again.”

「如果我將來有**機會**，我很想再跟他聊聊。」

Practice 2

> “I never had the **chance** to thank her properly.”

「我一直沒有**機會**好好感謝她。」

Practice 3

> “This job gives students a **chance** to gain practical experience.”

「這份工作讓學生有**機會**獲得實際經驗。」

****chance = 可以做、嘗試或經歷某件事情的機會 / 時機****

Common:

- * get a chance
- * have a chance
- * give someone a chance
- * chance to do something
- * another chance

2. ****chance = possibility / likelihood (可能性) — 可能性；機會率****

****Chance**** can mean how possible or likely it is that something will happen.

Practice 4

> “There is a good **chance** that it will rain tonight.”

「今晚**很有可能**會下雨。」

Practice 5

> “What are our **chances** of finishing on time?”

「我們按時完成的**可能性有多大**？」

****chance = 某件事情發生的可能性或機率****

Common:

- * a good chance
- * a slight chance
- * little chance
- * no chance
- * chance of doing something
- * chance that...

This is genuinely different from an opportunity.

Compare:

> “I had a chance to speak.”

= 我有機會說話。

> “There is a chance he will speak.”

= 他有可能會說話。

3. **chance = luck / randomness rather than deliberate control (偶然) — 偶然；機緣；隨機性
**

Chance can mean events happening without deliberate planning or a predictable cause.

Practice 6

> “We met by **chance** at the station.”

「我們在車站**偶然 / 碰巧**遇見。」

Practice 7

> “The discovery happened purely by **chance**.”

「這項發現完全是**偶然**發生的。」

chance = 事情並非經過刻意安排，而是偶然或隨機發生

Common:

- * by chance
- * pure chance
- * leave something to chance

This is a major distinct meaning.

4. **chance = risk / possibility of an unwanted result (冒險 / 風險) — 風險 ; 冒險**

In constructions such as **take a chance**, **chance** can mean accepting uncertainty or risk because something may succeed or fail.

Practice 8

> “I decided to take a **chance** and apply for the job.”

「我決定**冒一次險 / 試一試**，申請那份工作。」

Practice 9

> “You’re taking a big **chance** by ignoring the warning.”

「你無視警告是在**冒很大的風險**。」

take a chance = 在結果不確定的情況下冒險嘗試

This develops from the broader idea of uncertainty, but is useful enough to display explicitly.

For strict counting, I would group it with the **possibility/uncertainty** branch rather than make it completely separate.

5. **chance = possibility of success (勝算 / 希望) — 成功機會 ; 勝算**

Chance can specifically mean the possibility that a person will succeed.

Practice 10

> “She has a good **chance** of winning.”

「她有很大的**勝算 / 成功機會**。」

Practice 11

> “Without more preparation, we don’t stand much of a **chance**.”

「如果不多作準備，我們的**成功機會不大**。」

****chance = 某人取得成功、達成目標或獲勝的可能性****

For database counting, this belongs to Meaning 2.

6. ****chance = accidental/unplanned occurrence (偶然事件) — 巧合 ; 偶然事件****

In some contexts, ****a chance**** can refer to an accidental occurrence or coincidence.

Practice 12

> “A ****chance**** meeting changed the direction of his career.”

「一次****偶然的相遇****改變了他的職業方向。」

Practice 13

> “It was a ****chance**** discovery.”

「那是一項****偶然的發現****。」

Here, ****chance**** functions attributively before a noun:

****chance meeting/discovery = 並非預先安排、純屬偶然的相遇 / 發現****

This belongs semantically to Meaning 3.

7. ****chance = happen accidentally (動詞 , 較少見) — 碰巧 ; 偶然發生****

As a verb, ****chance**** can mean to happen by accident or without planning.

Practice 14

> “We ****chanced**** to meet again several years later.”

「幾年後我們又****碰巧****遇上了。」

Practice 15

> “I ****chanced**** upon an old photograph.”

「我****偶然發現****了一張舊照片。」

The second example uses a phrasal construction, **“chance upon”**, so under your operating procedure I would not treat it as part of the bare-word core entry by default.

The bare verb idea is:

“chance to do something = 碰巧做某事；偶然發生”

This is established but lower-frequency than the noun senses.

Related form: **“chancy”**

“Chancy” means uncertain and involving risk.

Practice 16

> “Driving in that weather would be **“chancy”**.”

「在那種天氣下開車會很**“冒險 / 有風險”**。」

Practice 17

> “It was a **“chancy”** investment.”

「那是一項**“風險很高 / 結果不確定的”**投資。」

“chancy = 結果不確定、帶有風險的”

This is useful but less common than **“risky”**.

Important distinction: **“chance vs opportunity”**

This is especially relevant to your original sentence.

“chance”

can mean:

- * opportunity
- * possibility
- * randomness/luck
- * risk

opportunity

mainly means:

> a suitable situation that makes it possible to do something

So:

> "I got the chance to speak."

≈

> "I got the opportunity to speak."

But:

> "There's a chance of rain."

cannot become:

> "There's an opportunity of rain." ❌

So **chance** is much more polysemous.

Important distinction: **chance vs possibility**

possibility

focuses directly on whether something can happen.

chance

can do the same, but often sounds more natural when probability or practical likelihood is being discussed.

> "There is a possibility of rain."

> "There is a chance of rain."

Both are natural.

But **chance** additionally has opportunity and randomness meanings.

Important distinction: **chance vs luck**

chance

often means randomness or events occurring without planning.

luck

usually evaluates whether accidental events are favourable or unfavourable to someone.

> “We met by chance.”

= 我們碰巧遇見。

> “We were lucky to meet.”

= 我們很幸運能遇見。

So:

chance = 偶然性本身

luck = 偶然事件帶來的好 / 壞運氣

Important distinction: **chance vs risk**

chance

can be neutral:

> chance of success

risk

usually emphasizes the possibility of something bad happening.

> risk of injury

So:

> “There is a chance we’ll succeed.”

positive/neutral.

> “There is a risk we’ll fail.”

negative.

Important distinction: **chance vs choice**

These are sometimes confused.

chance

= opportunity, possibility, randomness

choice

= decision between alternatives

> “Give me a chance.”

= 給我一次機會。

> “Give me a choice.”

= 給我選擇的權利 / 選項。

Completely different concepts.

Important distinction: **chance vs probability**

probability

is more formal and mathematical.

chance

is very common in everyday English.

> “There’s a 70% probability of rain.”

formal/technical.

> “There’s a good chance of rain.”

ordinary conversation.

Useful expression: **by chance — 偶然；碰巧**

Practice 18

> “Did you meet him by **chance**?”

「你是**碰巧**遇見他的嗎？」

Practice 19

> “I found the book by **chance**.”

「我是**偶然**找到那本書的。」

by chance = 並非刻意安排，而是偶然地

Useful expression: **take a chance — 冒險一試**

Practice 20

> “Sometimes you have to take a **chance**.”

「有時候你必須**冒險一試**。」

Practice 21

> “She took a **chance** and told him the truth.”

「她**冒險一試**，把真相告訴了他。」

Useful expression: **give someone a chance — 給某人機會**

Practice 22

> “Give him a **chance** to explain.”

「給他一個**機會**解釋。」

Practice 23

> “Everyone deserves a second **chance**.”

「每個人都值得有**第二次機會**。」

This belongs to the opportunity sense.

Useful expression: **stand a chance** — 有機會成功

Practice 24

> “We still stand a **chance** of winning.”

「我們仍然**有機會獲勝**。」

Practice 25

> “He doesn’t stand much of a **chance** without more practice.”

「如果不多加練習，他的**勝算不大**。」

stand a chance = 有一定的成功可能性

Useful expression: **no chance!** — 不可能！ / 想都別想！

Practice 26

> “Can I borrow your new car?”

> “No **chance**!”

「我可以借你的新車嗎？」

「**想都別想！ / 不可能！**」

This is informal and expresses strong refusal or impossibility.

It develops from the **possibility** sense.

Useful expression: **leave something to chance** — 任由偶然決定

Practice 27

> “We planned everything carefully and left nothing to **chance**.”

「我們仔細規劃所有事情，不讓任何事情**聽天由命 / 由偶然決定**。」

Practice 28

> “Don’t leave your future to **chance**.”

「不要讓自己的未來**任由運氣 / 偶然決定**。」

This belongs to the randomness sense.

Countability note

Chance behaves differently by sense.

Countable: opportunity / possibility

- > a chance
- > two chances
- > another chance

Often uncountable: randomness

- > by chance
- > pure chance
- > leave it to chance

So:

- > “I had a chance to speak.” 
- > “We met by chance.” 

The Golden Manual recommends noting countability where it materially changes natural usage.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **chance**
 * **chances**
 * **chanced**
 * **chancing**
 * **chancy**

Useful constructions include:

* have/get a chance
 * give someone a chance
 * chance to do something
 * chance of something
 * chance that...
 * by chance
 * take a chance
 * stand a chance
 * leave something to chance
 * chance meeting

The Golden Manual requires both grammatical constructions and figurative uses to be checked, while overlapping uses should still be merged when the underlying semantic concept remains the same.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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chance — opportunity	可以做、嘗試或經歷某件事情的機會 / 合適時機
chance — possibility	某件事情發生或成功的可能性 / 機率
chance — randomness	事情並非經過刻意安排，而是偶然或隨機發生的情況
take a chance — risk	在結果不確定的情況下冒險嘗試；屬於 uncertainty 義
chance meeting/discovery	沒有預先安排、純屬偶然發生的相遇 / 發現
chance — verb	碰巧發生或碰巧做某事；較低頻
chancy	結果不確定並帶有風險的

For your original sentence

> “If I ever got the **chance**, I would love to sit down with him again...”

The exact meaning is:

chance = 可以做某件事情的機會或合適時機

So:

> **get the chance to talk to him again**

= **得到機會再跟他談談 / 有機會再跟他聊天**

This is **opportunity**, not probability or luck.

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely useful core meanings** for **chance**:

1. **opportunity to do something**
2. **possibility / likelihood that something will happen or succeed**
3. **randomness / accidental occurrence**

I would keep **take a chance** under #2 as an uncertainty/risk extension, keep **chance meeting / by chance / leave to chance** under #3, and treat the verb **chance** and adjective **chancy** as lower-priority family extensions rather than inflate the main core count.